

The Department of Defense and its Correspondence Relationship with Legislators

PS 699: Independent Study (Spring 2020)

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Data

Altogether we have 7635 letters received by the Department of Defense that are marked as “congressional” from 2007-2017. All of these letters are from Members of the U.S. Congress. Note: During my independent study, I handcoded approximately 3,492 letters from a variety of Department of Defense agencies. Unfortunately, we were not able to implement these observations into the final data set. Thus, observations that are missing a Policy Type Category have a current Type of NA.

```
load(here("data/all_contacts.RData"))  
# one obs per member per letter for all agencies  
d <- all_contacts %>% filter(str_detect(agency, "DOD")) %>% filter(year <2018, year >2006) # 2007-2017
```

A Potential Outlier

In this analysis, Senator Grassley (R-IA) is considered to be an outlier. He wrote 188 letters to the Department of Defense, the most out of any other members of congress. However, he was never a part of any committee that actively work for the Department of Defense. Although at this point, we are unable to see what are the policy categories of the letters he wrote to the Department of Defense, based off of the hand-coding I did, Grassley wrote a majority of his letters on behalf of constituents, specifically for Veterans in Iowa. On further analysis, Grassley's campaign has largely been based on providing veterans in Iowa opportunities to present their legacy to other residents in Iowa and the US, and more within the realm of congressional agencies, aid with ensuring that veterans receive their benefits after retiring or being discharged from the military. These benefits include disability compensation, education programs, health benefits, and more. A majority of these concerns would be best addressed via the Department of Veteran Affairs versus most of the Department of Defense agencies, however, many of the issues, such as Military Pay complaints as well as sexual harrassment allegations can indeed be addressed with the Department of Defense agencies, such as the Department of Defense and Accounting Service (DFAS) as well as the Office of the Inspector General, U.S. Department of Defense (DOD_OIG). Thus, at this time, I am not considering Senator Grassley to be an outlier in our analysis.

```
dc <- all_contacts %>% filter(str_detect(agency, "DOD")) %>% filter(year <2018, year >2006) %>% filter(
dc %>% count(bioname,party, TYPE, cqlabel, sort = T) %>% top_n(10, n) %>% kable(caption = "Policy Catego
```

Table 1: Policy Categories within Grassley's Letters to the DOD

bioname	party	TYPE	cqlabel	n
GRASSLEY, Charles Ernest	(R)	NA	(IA)	168
GRASSLEY, Charles Ernest	(R)	1	(IA)	19
GRASSLEY, Charles Ernest	(R)	5	(IA)	1

Top 10 Legislators who wrote the most letters to the DOD

```
# top overall
d %>% count(bioname,party,cqlabel, sort = T) %>% top_n(10, n) %>% kable(caption = "Legislators who wrote
```

Table 2: Legislators who wrote the most letters to DOD

bioname	party	cqlabel	n
GRASSLEY, Charles Ernest	(R)	(IA)	188
McCAIN, John Sidney, III	(R)	(AZ)	116
FORBES, J. Randy	(R)	(VA-04)	86
NELSON, Clarence William (Bill)	(D)	(FL)	84
BURR, Richard M.	(R)	(NC)	75
McCASKILL, Claire	(D)	(MO)	70
TOOMEY, Patrick Joseph	(R)	(PA)	60
WITTMAN, Robert J.	(R)	(VA-01)	60
BOOZMAN, John	(R)	(AR)	59
HUNTER, Duncan Duane	(R)	(CA-50)	59
PELOSI, Nancy	(D)	(CA-08)	59

```
d %>% count(bioname,party, TYPE, cqlabel, sort = T) %>% top_n(10, n) %>% kable(caption = "Legislators w
```

Table 3: Legislators who wrote the most letters to DOD

bioname	party	TYPE	cqlabel	n
GRASSLEY, Charles Ernest	(R)	NA	(IA)	168
FORBES, J. Randy	(R)	NA	(VA-04)	58
McCAIN, John Sidney, III	(R)	NA	(AZ)	58
McCASKILL, Claire	(D)	NA	(MO)	52
NELSON, Clarence William (Bill)	(D)	1	(FL)	50
BOOZMAN, John	(R)	1	(AR)	48
McCAIN, John Sidney, III	(R)	1	(AZ)	46
WEBB, James H. (Jim)	(D)	NA	(VA)	45
PELOSI, Nancy	(D)	6	(CA-08)	43
TOOMEY, Patrick Joseph	(R)	1	(PA)	40

```
##FILTER OUT NA??
```

```
d %>% count(TYPE,sort = T) %>% filter(!(is.na(TYPE))) %>% top_n(10, n) %>% kable(caption = "Most Common
```

Table 4: Most Common Policy Areas

TYPE	n
1	3798
5	149
6	88
0	43
2	35
3	25
4	3

```
##Types of Policy each member dealt with
```

```
d %>% count(bioname,party, TYPE, cqlabel, sort = T) %>% top_n(10, n) %>% kable(caption = "Legislators w
```

Table 5: Legislators who wrote the most letters to DOD

bioname	party	TYPE	cqlabel	n
GRASSLEY, Charles Ernest	(R)	NA	(IA)	168
FORBES, J. Randy	(R)	NA	(VA-04)	58
McCAIN, John Sidney, III	(R)	NA	(AZ)	58
McCASKILL, Claire	(D)	NA	(MO)	52
NELSON, Clarence William (Bill)	(D)	1	(FL)	50
BOOZMAN, John	(R)	1	(AR)	48
McCAIN, John Sidney, III	(R)	1	(AZ)	46
WEBB, James H. (Jim)	(D)	NA	(VA)	45
PELOSI, Nancy	(D)	6	(CA-08)	43

bioname	party	TYPE	cqlabel	n
TOOMEY, Patrick Joseph	(R)	1	(PA)	40

##COULD ANYTHING BE DONE HERE

```
# most with a given position
# d %>% count(bioname, party, cqlabel, letter_position, sort = T) %>% filter(letter_position != "Other")

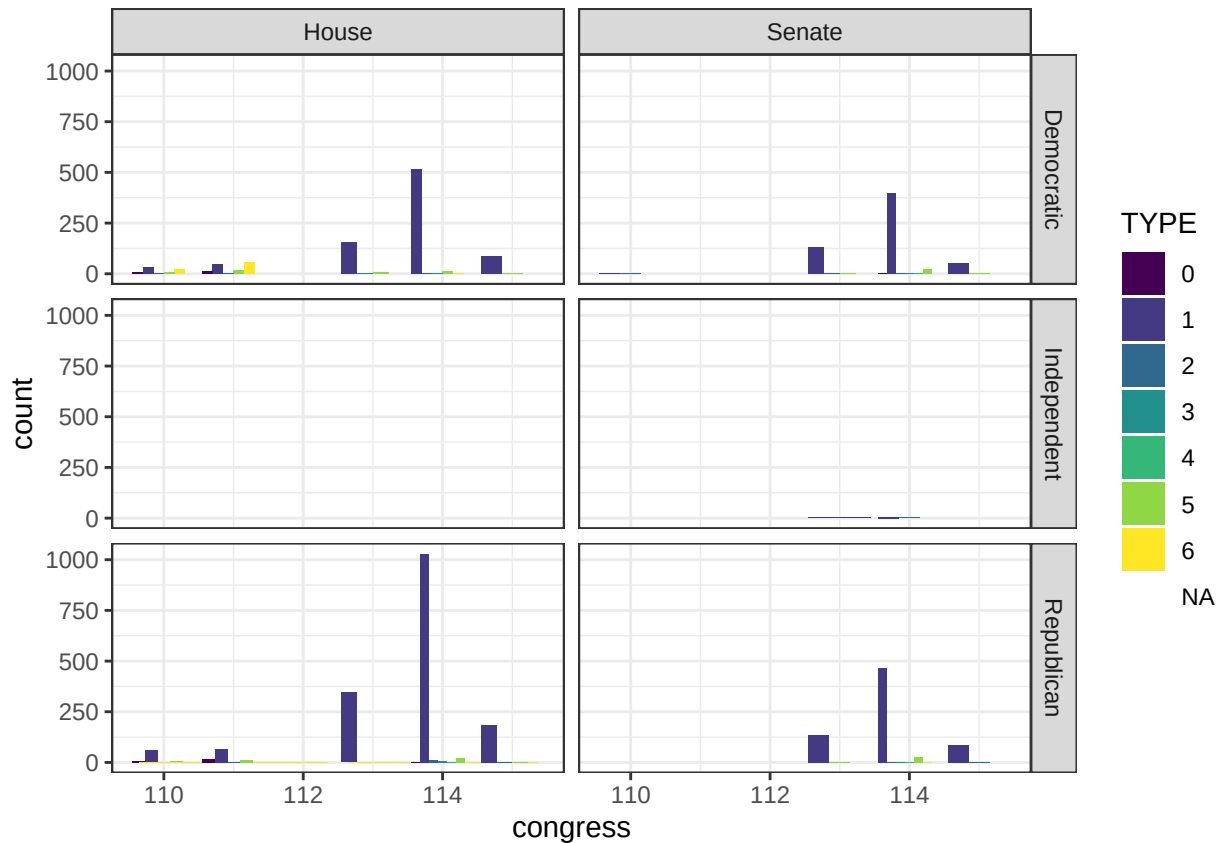
# most with a given position in a cycle
d %>% count(bioname, party, cqlabel, TYPE, congress, sort = T) %>% filter(TYPE != "Other") %>% top_n(10)
```

Table 6: Most frequent letter positions for a given legislator in a cycle

bioname	party	cqlabel	TYPE	congress	n
NELSON, Clarence William (Bill)	(D)	(FL)	1	114	39
BOOZMAN, John	(R)	(AR)	1	114	37
TOOMEY, Patrick Joseph	(R)	(PA)	1	114	32
BURR, Richard M.	(R)	(NC)	1	114	30
PELOSI, Nancy	(D)	(CA-08)	6	111	29
OBEY, David Ross	(D)	(WI-07)	6	111	28
KAINE, Timothy Michael (Tim)	(D)	(VA)	1	114	26
MURRAY, Patty	(D)	(WA)	1	114	25
RIGELL, E. Scott	(R)	(VA-02)	1	114	25
DAVIS, Susan A.	(D)	(CA-53)	1	114	24
McCAIN, John Sidney, III	(R)	(AZ)	1	114	24

```
#
# # d %>% filter(str_detect(SUBJECT, "forwards")) %>% add_count(bioname, sort = T) %>% top_n(1, n) %>%
#
d %>%
  ggplot() +
  aes(x = congress, fill = TYPE) +
  geom_bar(position = "dodge") +
  facet_grid(party_name ~ chamber)
```

Warning: position_dodge requires non-overlapping x intervals



###Senators and Veteran Population ###HELP WITH THIS #Representative per district??

```
vet_states <- read.csv(here("vetpop2010.csv"))
#vet_states <- read.csv("DOD Fatima (Independent Study)/vetpop2010.csv")
vet_states$state %<>% tolower()
vet_states$vetpop2010 <- gsub(",", "", vet_states$vetpop2010)
vet_states$vetpop2010 %<>% as.numeric()
#write.csv(vet_states, "DOD Fatima (Independent Study)/vetpop2010.csv")

vet_states %<>% select(state, vetpop2010)
d %<>% left_join(vet_states)
```

Joining, by = "state"

```
d %>%
  filter(chamber == "Senate") %>%
  group_by(member_state, year, vetpop2010) %>% summarise(n = n()) %>%
  group_by(member_state, vetpop2010) %>% summarise(mean = mean(n)) %>% ungroup() %>%
  ggplot() +
  geom_point(aes(x = log(vetpop2010), y = mean), color = "light blue") +
  geom_smooth(aes(x = log(vetpop2010), y = mean)) +
  geom_text(aes(x = log(vetpop2010),
    y = mean,
    label = ifelse(mean > mean(mean)*1.5 | mean < mean(mean)*0.5,
      member_state, "")),
```

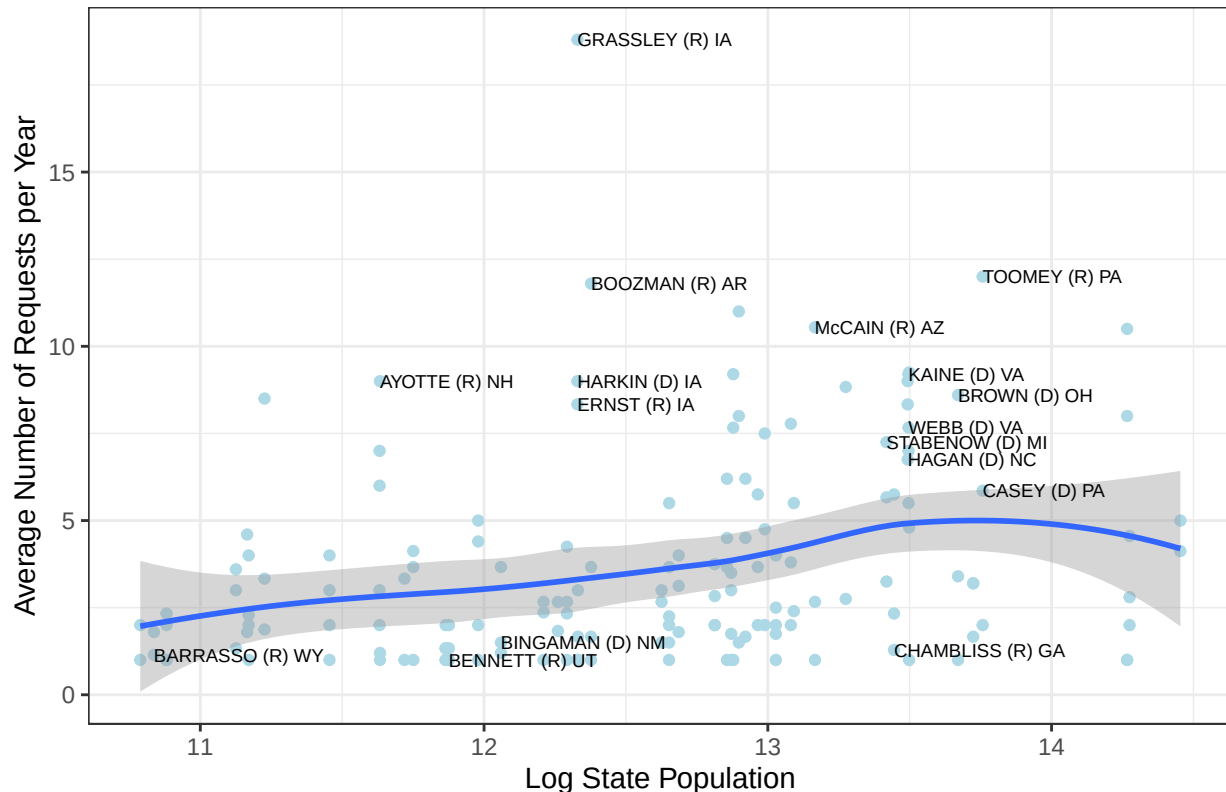
```

    check_overlap = TRUE,
    size = 2.5,
    hjust = 0) +
  theme_bw() +
  labs(title = "Senator Requests per Year by State Population",
    x = "Log State Population",
    y = "Average Number of Requests per Year")

```

```
## `geom_smooth()` using method = 'loess' and formula 'y ~ x'
```

Senator Requests per Year by State Population



```
Chamber = "Senate"
```

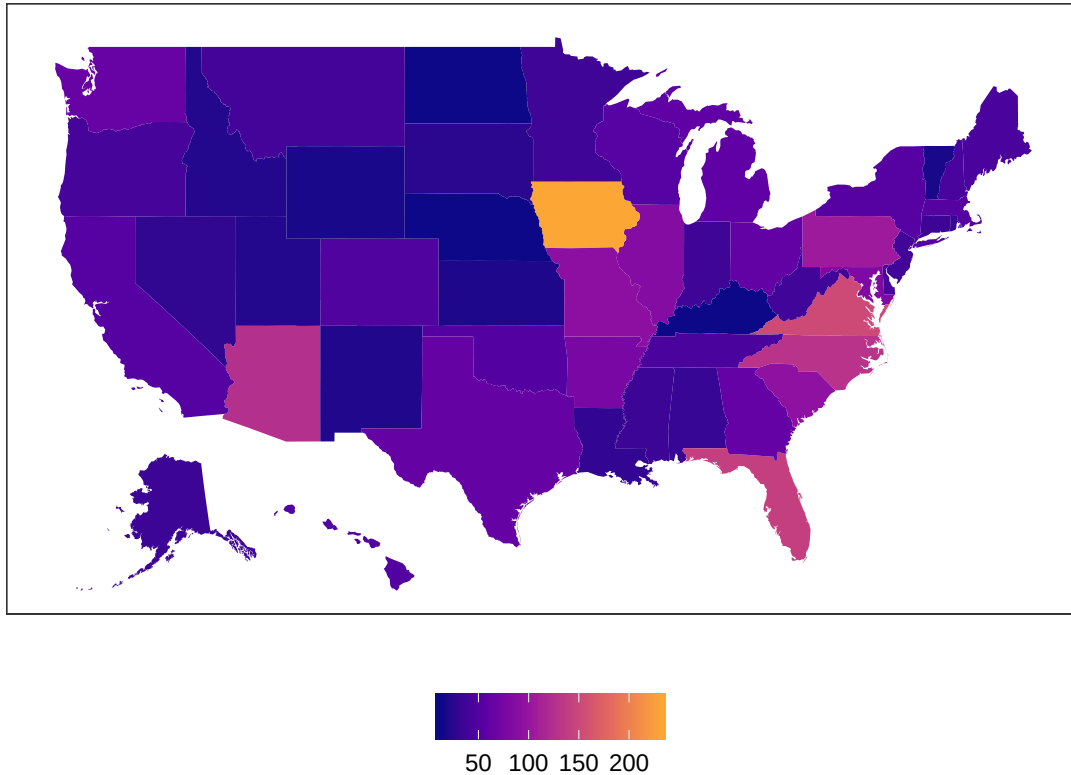
```

d %>%
  ungroup() %>%
  filter(chamber == Chamber) %>%
  group_by(state) %>% summarise(n = n()) %>%
  # map_id creates the aesthetic mapping to the state name column
  ggplot() +
  # map points to the fifty_states shape data
  geom_map(aes(map_id = state, fill = n), map = fifty_states) +
  expand_limits(x = fifty_states$long, y = fifty_states$lat) +
  coord_map() +
  scale_x_continuous(breaks = NULL) +
  scale_y_continuous(breaks = NULL) +
  labs(x = "", y = "", title = paste("Total Number of Contacts from members of the", Chamber)) +

```

```
scale_fill_viridis_c(option = "C", end = .8) +
theme(legend.position = "bottom", legend.title = element_blank(),
      panel.background = element_blank()) # + facet_grid(. ~ Constituent)
```

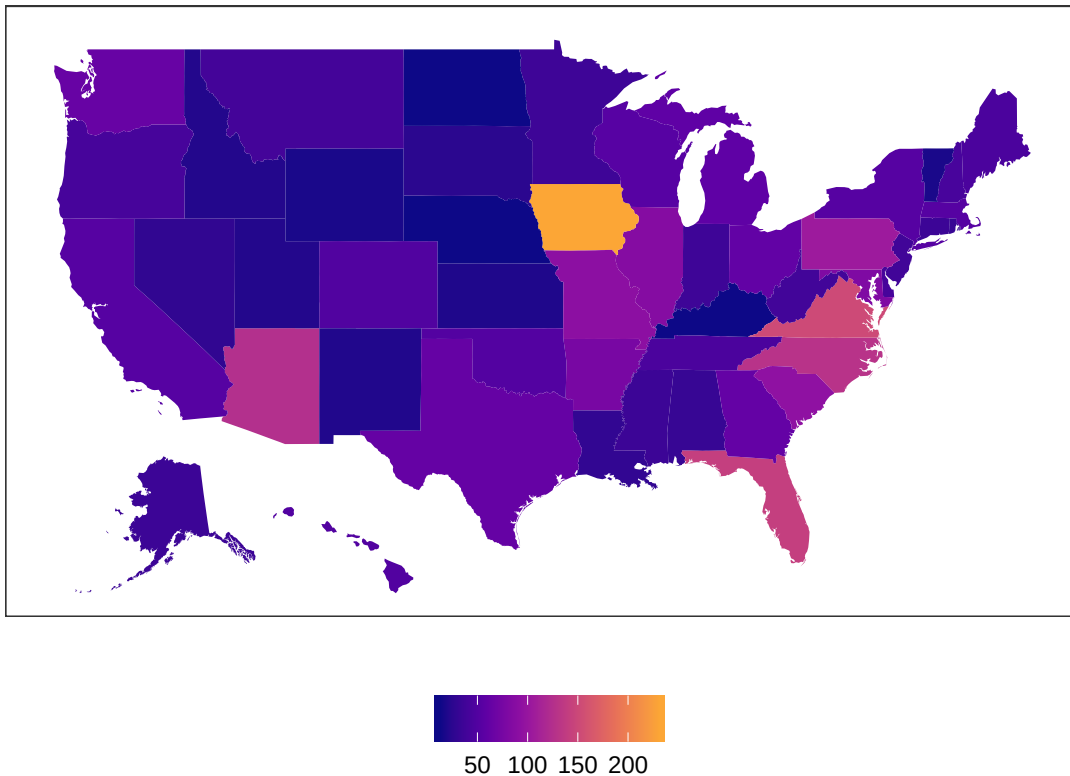
Total Number of Contacts from members of the Senate



```
Chamber = "Senate"

d %>%
  ungroup() %>%
  filter(chamber == Chamber) %>%
  group_by(state) %>% summarise(n = n()) %>%
  # map_id creates the aesthetic mapping to the state name column
  ggplot() +
  # map points to the fifty_states shape data
  geom_map(aes(map_id = state, fill = n), map = fifty_states) +
  expand_limits(x = fifty_states$long, y = fifty_states$lat) +
  coord_map() +
  scale_x_continuous(breaks = NULL) +
  scale_y_continuous(breaks = NULL) +
  labs(x = "", y = "", title = paste("Total Number of Contacts from members of the", Chamber)) +
  scale_fill_viridis_c(option = "C", end = .8) +
  theme(legend.position = "bottom", legend.title = element_blank(),
        panel.background = element_blank()) # + facet_grid(. ~ Constituent)
```

Total Number of Contacts from members of the Senate

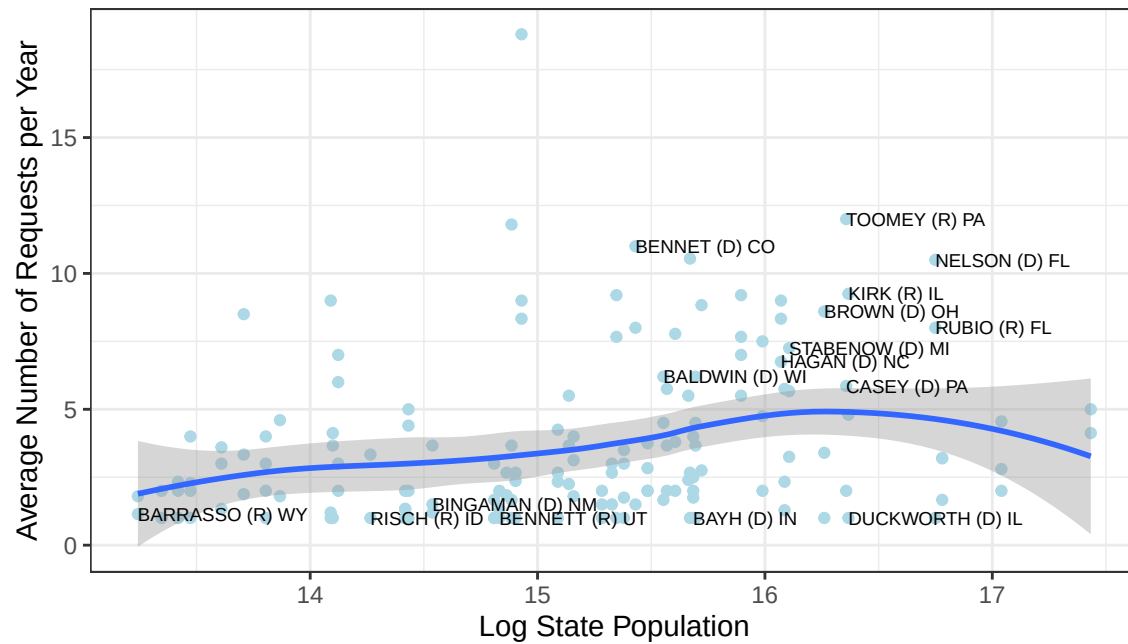


Senators vs. state population

```
d %>%
  filter(chamber == "Senate") %>%
  group_by(member_state, year, pop2010) %>% summarise(n = n()) %>%
  group_by(member_state, pop2010) %>% summarise(mean = mean(n)) %>% ungroup() %>%
  ggplot() +
    geom_point(aes(x = log(pop2010), y = mean), color = "light blue") +
    geom_smooth(aes(x = log(pop2010), y = mean)) +
    geom_text(aes(x = log(pop2010),
                  y = mean,
                  label = ifelse(mean > mean(mean)*1.5 | mean < mean(mean)*0.5,
                                member_state, "")),
              check_overlap = TRUE,
              size = 2.5,
              hjust = 0) +
  theme_bw() +
  labs(title = "Senator Requests per Year by State Population",
       x = "Log State Population",
       y = "Average Number of Requests per Year")
```

```
## `geom_smooth()` using method = 'loess' and formula 'y ~ x'
```

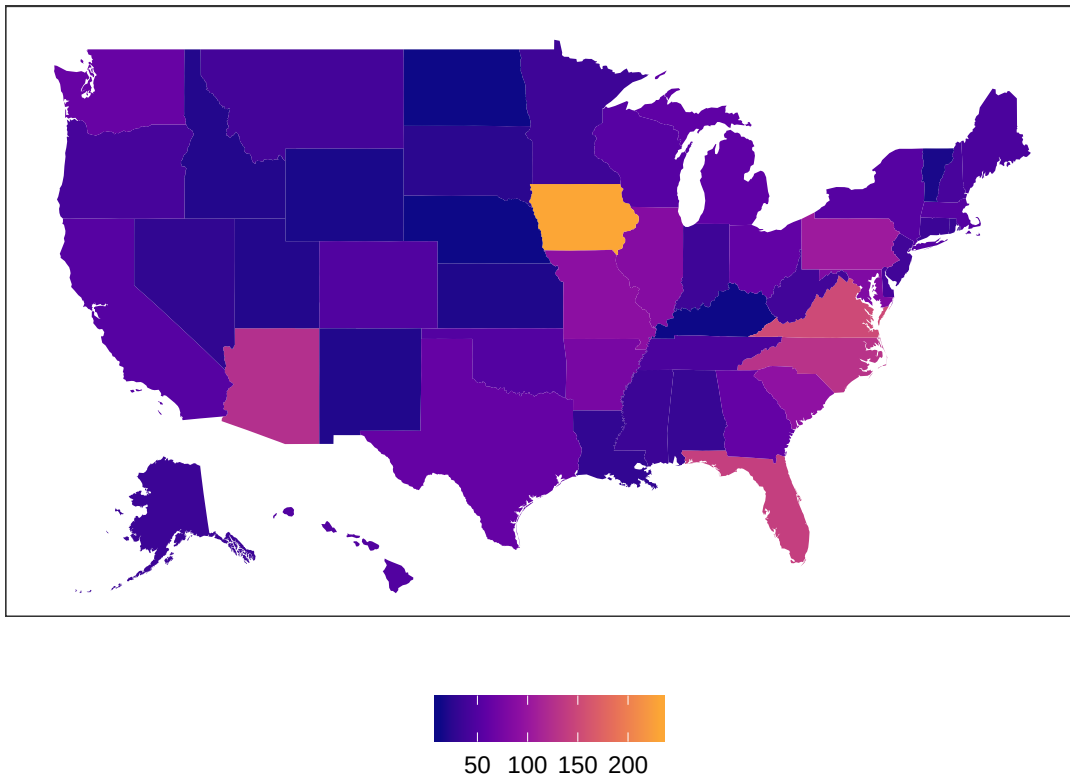

Senator Requests per Year by State Population



```
Chamber = "Senate"

d %>%
  ungroup() %>%
  filter(chamber == Chamber) %>%
  group_by(state) %>% summarise(n = n()) %>%
  # map_id creates the aesthetic mapping to the state name column
  ggplot() +
  # map points to the fifty_states shape data
  geom_map(aes(map_id = state, fill = n), map = fifty_states) +
  expand_limits(x = fifty_states$long, y = fifty_states$lat) +
  coord_map() +
  scale_x_continuous(breaks = NULL) +
  scale_y_continuous(breaks = NULL) +
  labs(x = "", y = "", title = paste("Total Number of Contacts from members of the", Chamber)) +
  scale_fill_viridis_c(option = "C", end = .8) +
  theme(legend.position = "bottom", legend.title = element_blank(),
        panel.background = element_blank()) # + facet_grid(. ~ Constituent)
```

Total Number of Contacts from members of the Senate



##What on earth is happening here?

```
# d %>%
#   ungroup() %>%
#   filter(chamber == Chamber) %>%
#   group_by(state, pop2010) %>% summarise(n = n()) %>% ungroup() %>%
#   mutate(Per_Capita = n/pop2010*1000000) %>%
#   # map_id creates the aesthetic mapping to the state name column in your data
#   ggplot() +
#   # map points to the fifty_states shape data
#   geom_map(aes(map_id = state, fill = Per_Capita), map = fifty_states) +
#   expand_limits(x = fifty_states$long, y = fifty_states$lat) +
#   coord_map() +
#   scale_x_continuous(breaks = NULL) +
#   scale_y_continuous(breaks = NULL) +
#   labs(x = "", y = "", title = paste("Contacts Per hundred thousand Residents from Members of the", C
#   scale_fill_viridis_c(option = "C", end = .8) +
#   theme(legend.position = "bottom",
#         legend.title = element_blank() )#+facet_grid(. ~ Constituent)
#
##Copy. Add constituent for type 1
#
# d %>%
#   mutate(Per_Capita = (pop2010)*1000000) %>% ##FIXME non-numeric argument to binary operator
#   # map_id creates the aesthetic mapping to the state name column in your data
#   ggplot() +
```

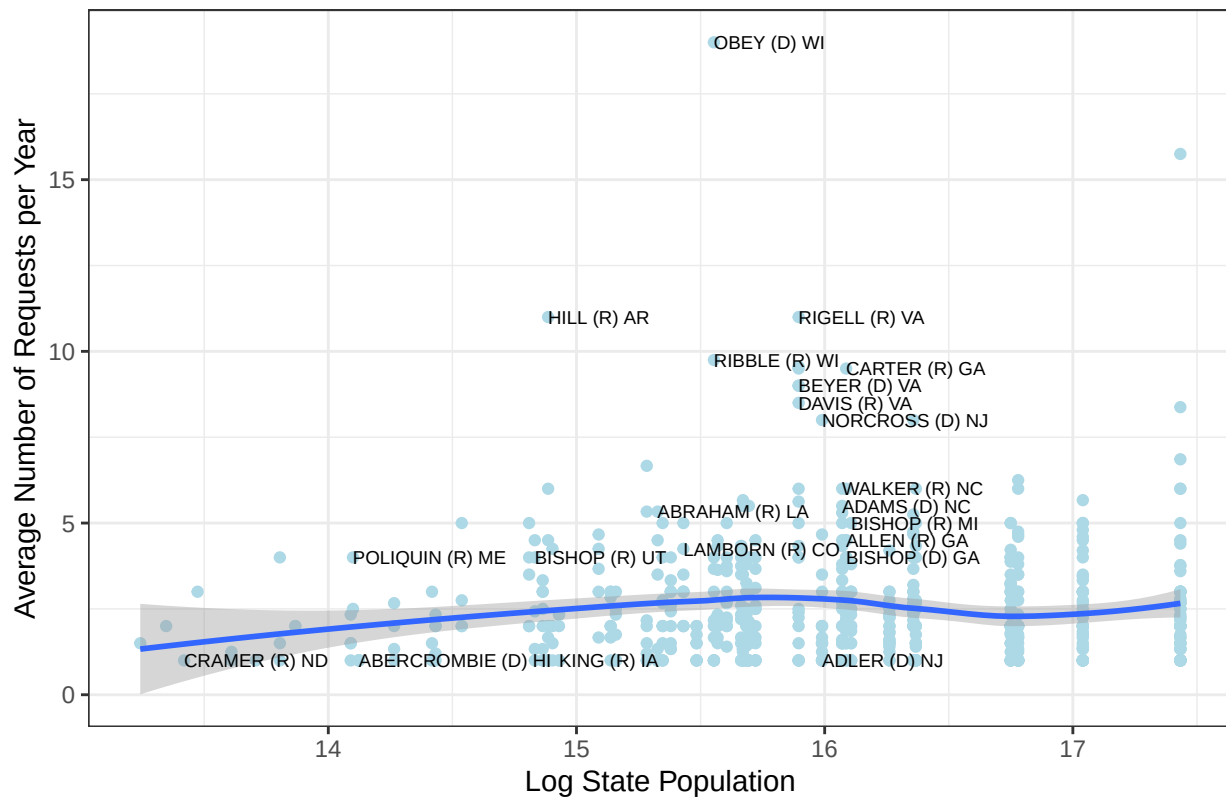
```
# # map points to the fifty_states shape data
# geom_map(aes(map_id = state, fill = Per_Capita), map = fifty_states) +
# expand_limits(x = fifty_states$long, y = fifty_states$lat) +
# coord_map() +
# scale_x_continuous(breaks = NULL) +
# scale_y_continuous(breaks = NULL) +
# labs(x = "", y = "", title = paste("Contacts Per hundred thousand Residents from Members of the", C
# scale_fill_viridis_c(option = "C", end = .8) +
# theme(legend.position = "bottom",
#       legend.title = element_blank() )+
# facet_grid(. ~ Constituent)
```

##House Contacts per State ##Contacts per district ##Would this be relevantt??

```
d %>%
  filter(chamber == "House") %>%
  group_by(member_state, year, pop2010) %>% summarise(n = n()) %>%
  group_by(member_state, pop2010) %>% summarise(mean = mean(n)) %>% ungroup() %>%
  ggplot() +
  geom_point(aes(x = log(pop2010), y = mean), color = "light blue") +
  geom_smooth(aes(x = log(pop2010), y = mean)) +
  geom_text(aes(x = log(pop2010),
                y = mean,
                label = ifelse(mean > mean(mean)*1.5 | mean < mean(mean)*0.5,
                              member_state, "")),
            check_overlap = TRUE,
            size = 2.5,
            hjust = 0) +
  theme_bw() +
  labs(title = "House Requests per Year by State Population",
       x = "Log State Population",
       y = "Average Number of Requests per Year")
```

`geom\_smooth()` using method = 'loess' and formula 'y ~ x'

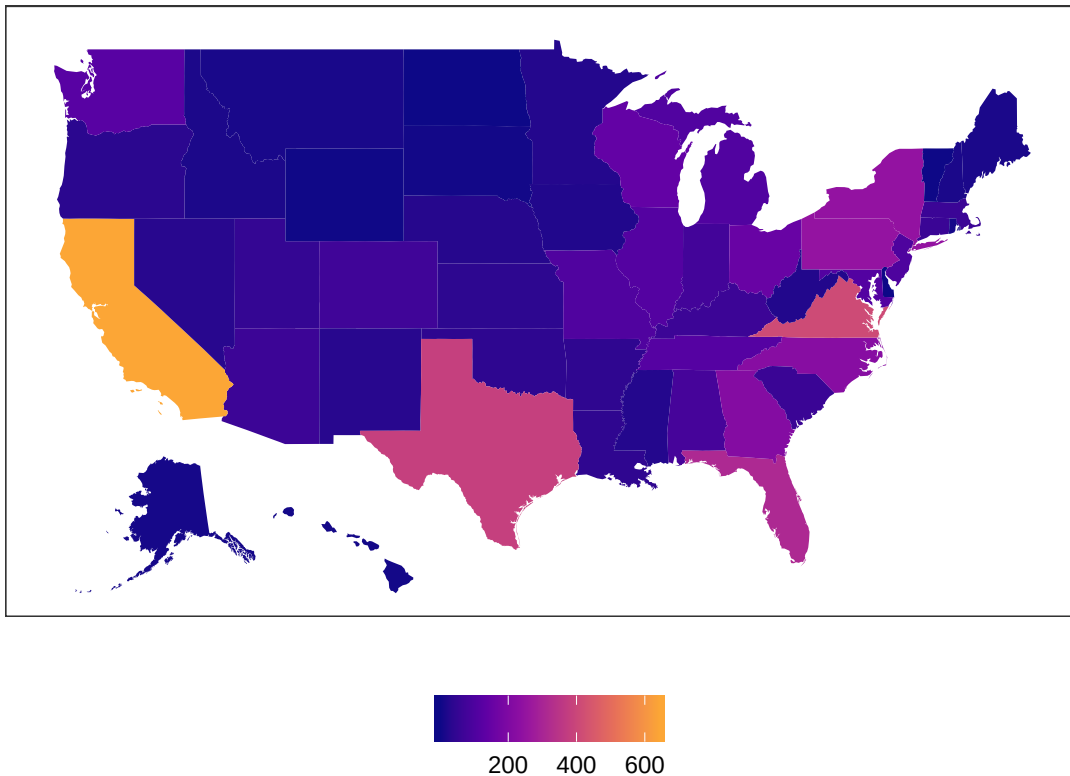
House Requests per Year by State Population



```
Chamber = "House"
```

```
d %>%
  ungroup() %>%
  filter(chamber == Chamber) %>%
  group_by(state) %>% summarise(n = n()) %>%
  # map_id creates the aesthetic mapping to the state name column
  ggplot() +
    # map points to the fifty_states shape data
    geom_map(aes(map_id = state, fill = n), map = fifty_states) +
    expand_limits(x = fifty_states$long, y = fifty_states$lat) +
    coord_map() +
    scale_x_continuous(breaks = NULL) +
    scale_y_continuous(breaks = NULL) +
    labs(x = "", y = "", title = paste("Total Number of Contacts from members of the", Chamber)) +
    scale_fill_viridis_c(option = "C", end = .8) +
    theme(legend.position = "bottom", legend.title = element_blank(),
          panel.background = element_blank()) # + facet_grid(. ~ Constituent)
```

Total Number of Contacts from members of the House

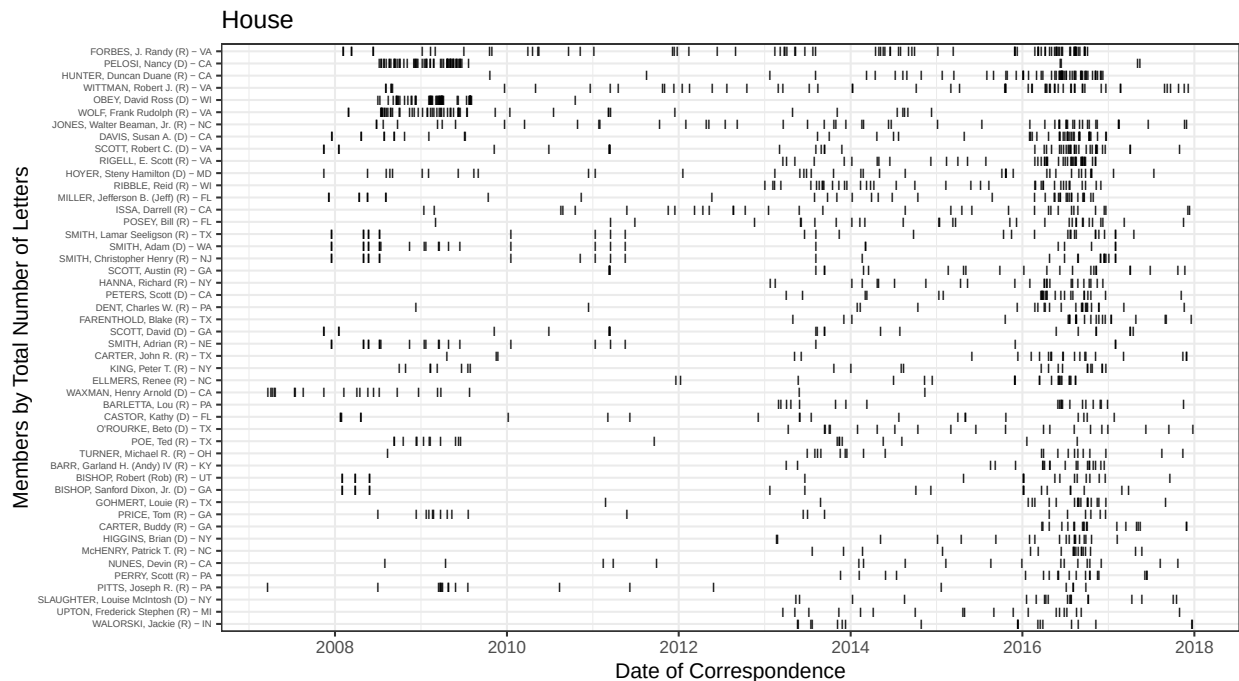


Members who contact DOD more than average:

```
# barcode plot of committee members

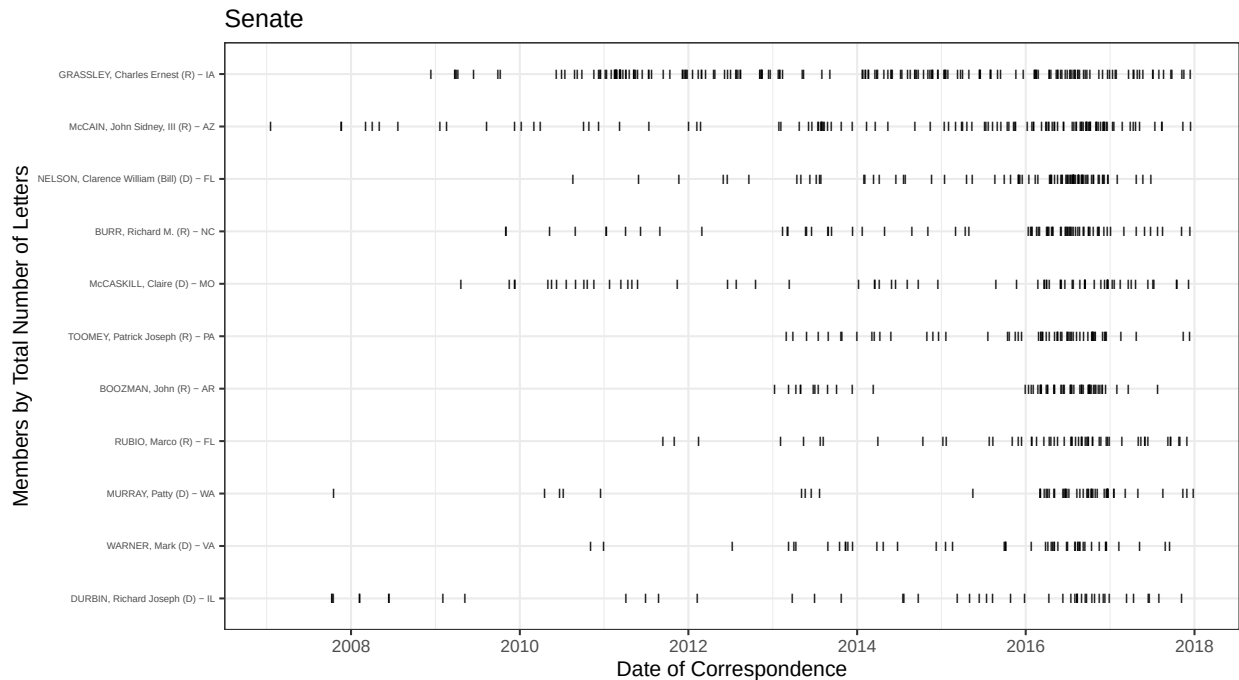
# member by year by agency
d %>%
  filter(chamber == Chamber) %>%
  group_by(name_state) %>% mutate(n = n()) %>% ungroup() %>%
  filter(n > mean(n)) %>%
  ggplot() +
  geom_point(
    aes(x = DATE,
        y = reorder(name_state, n) ),
    # alpha = .6,
    shape = 73,
    size=2
  ) +
  labs(title = paste(Chamber),
       y = paste("Members by", "Total Number of Letters"),
       x = "Date of Correspondence" ) +
  theme(
    legend.title = element_blank(),
```

```
axis.text.y = element_text(size=5)
) +
guides(fill=guide_legend(ncol=1))
```



```
Chamber <- "Senate" # "Senate"

# member by year by agency
d %>%
  filter(chamber == Chamber) %>%
  group_by(name_state) %>% mutate(n = n()) %>% ungroup() %>%
  filter(n > mean(n)) %>%
  ggplot() +
  geom_point(
    aes(x = DATE,
        y = reorder(name_state, n) ),
    # alpha = .6,
    shape = 73,
    size=2
  ) +
  labs(title = paste(Chamber),
       y = paste("Members by", "Total Number of Letters"),
       x = "Date of Correspondence" ) +
  theme(
    legend.title = element_blank(),
    axis.text.y = element_text(size=5)
  ) +
  guides(fill=guide_legend(ncol=1))
```



Members who contact DOD more, relative to other agencies:

```
# all_contacts %>%
# filter(congress >109) %>%
# mutate(DOD = agency == "DOD_OSDJS") %>%
# count(chamber, OSDJS, name_state, state) %>%
# spread(key = "OSDJS", value = "n", 0) %>%
# mutate(ShareToOSDJS = round(`TRUE`/(`TRUE`+`FALSE`),2) ) %>%
# arrange(-ShareToOSDJS) %>%
# mutate(total = `TRUE` + `FALSE`) %>%
# select(name_state, chamber, total, ShareToFERC) %>%
# filter(ShareToOSDJS>.3) %>%
# knitr::kable(caption = "Members who contact FERC more, relative to other agencies" )
#
#
# # facet on agency, how does it differ across agencies
#
# chamber <- "Senate" # "Senate" #why does it say False?
#
# all_contacts %>%
# filter(chamber == "Senate") %>%
# #filter(str_detect(agency, "DOD")) %>%
# mutate(DOD = agency == "DOD_OSDJS") %>%
# group_by(chamber, Department, name_state, state) %>%
# summarise(n = n() ) %>%
# ungroup() %>%
# #spread(key = "DOD", value = n) %>%
# top_n(10, n) %>%
# knitr::kable()
```

```

#
# # mutate(ShareToDOD = round(`TRUE`/(`TRUE`+`FALSE`),2) ) %>%
# # arrange(-ShareToDOD) %>%
# # mutate(total = `TRUE` + `FALSE`) %>%
# # select(name_state, chamber, total, ShareToDOD) %>%
# # filter(ShareToDOD>.3) %>%
#
#
# chamber <- "House"
#
# all_contacts %>%
#   filter(chamber == "House") %>% #why is this working this way??
#   mutate(DOD = agency == "DOD$") %>%
#   group_by(chamber, DOD, name_state, state) %>%
#   summarise(n = n() ) %>%
#   ungroup() %>%
#   #spread(key = "DOD", value = n) %>%
#   top_n(10, n) %>%
#   knitr::kable()
#
# ## Members who contact FERC more in a Congress, relative to other agencies

```

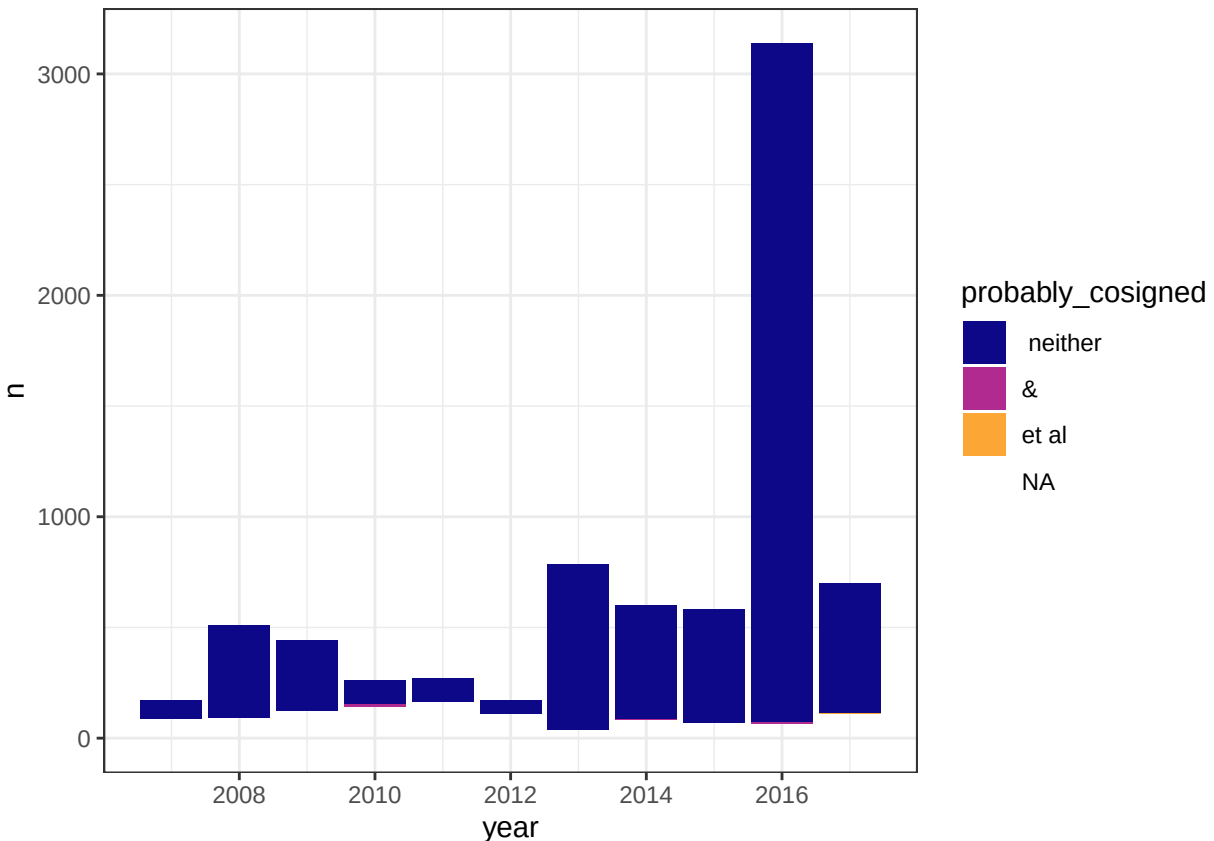
Many letters to DOD are cosigned

#A rough under-estimate based on whether “et al” or “&” appears in the summary: # INVESTIGATE

```

d %>%
  group_by(ID) %>%
  mutate(probably_cosigned = ifelse(str_detect(SUBJECT, "et al"), "et al",
                                     ifelse(str_detect(SUBJECT, "&"), "&", " neither"))) %>%
  group_by(year, probably_cosigned) %>%
  tally %>%
  ggplot() +
  aes(x = year, y = n, fill = probably_cosigned) +
  geom_col() +
  scale_fill_viridis_d(option = "C", end = .8)

```

##How to fix this committee Code

#Left join committees into all_contacts #Group by ICPSR and Congress #Summarize committees = paste committee #Full join of all contacts and committees, larger data set

Modify committees variable, ICPSR, Congress, Committee= Armed Services

```
# d %>%
#   mutate(chair = str_remove(chair, "[0-9]* |^NA "),
#          committee = paste(chamber, committees))%>%
#   dplyr::select(committee, position, chair, DATE, assigneddate, terminationdate) %>%
#   distinct() %>%
#   filter(str_detect(committee, "ENERGY$|ENVIRONMENT|NATURAL")) %>%
#   mutate(position = ifelse(position == "Other", NA, position)) %>%
#   #filter(!is.na(position), chair_since_2007 == T) %>%
#   drop_na(chair) %>%
#   dplyr::select(DATE, chair, position, assigneddate, terminationdate, committee) %>%
#   distinct() %>%
#   ggplot() +
#   geom_point(
#     aes(x = DATE,
#          y = chair),
#     shape = 73,
```

```

#   size=2
# ) +
#   geom_segment(aes(y = chair, yend = chair,
#                     x = date, xend = date,
#                     linetype = factor(position)),
#               position = position_nudge(y = -0.3)) +
#   labs(title = paste("Letters to FERC from Committee Leadership"),
#        y = "",
#        x = "",
#        linetype = "Leadership position") +
#   scale_y_discrete(position = "right") +
#   theme(
#     strip.text.y = element_text(angle = 180, size = 5),
#     # legend.title = element_blank(),
#     axis.text.y = element_text(size=5),
#     axis.text.x = element_text(angle = 0)
#   ) +
#   facet_grid(committee ~ ., scales = "free_y", space = "free_y", switch = "both")

# MEMBER DEMOGRAPHICS

# gender for those where we have the data from LEP # WE HAVE BETTER DATA, NEEDS TO BE MERGED IN
d %<>%
  # merge LEP data into df
  left_join(
    # read in the LEP data
    read.csv(here("members/LEP111to113.csv")) %>%
      # just grabbing female variable for now
      select(icpsr, female) %>%
      # distinct icpsr-gender combinations
      distinct() %>%
      #make ICPSR numbers numeric to merge with df
      mutate(icpsr = as.numeric(icpsr))
  )

```

```
## Joining, by = c("icpsr", "female")
```

```
## Warning: Column `female` joining character vector and factor, coercing into
## character vector
```

Limitations throughout the Independent Study

Throughout the course of this independent study, there were a few challenges and limitations I faced.

Future ideas to explore with this paper

In the future, I hope to continue my exploration with this topic by

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Notes:

1. Count letters by member by year (including zero counts)
2. Policy Stuff
3. Divide by years--annualized by years
4. Control with Gender--how long they're in congress
5. Veterans--More likely to write, shared Veteran status. Veterans-gender-bias
6. What Kind of Variate Models??--Pro-business/anti-business/Constituent vs. everyone else/ Party Explanatory #Party # constituent vs non constituent
7. Best way to present paper..like this or should I hide code?? #HTML
8. Electoral Interests?--how to measure that? #Most important issue data #State